

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Recruitment, Selection & Onboarding

Human Resources Department

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines the standard process to be followed by the Human Resources (HR) department for identifying manpower needs, sourcing and screening candidates, conducting interviews, extending offers, and onboarding new employees. It ensures a consistent, fair, and efficient hiring experience for both the organization and candidates.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all recruitment activities across departments and job levels within the organization, from the point a vacancy is identified until the new hire completes onboarding and is confirmed as an active employee. It covers permanent, contractual, and internship hiring.

3. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Hiring Manager	Raises manpower requisition, defines job requirements, participates in technical interviews, and approves final selection.
HR Recruiter	Sources candidates, screens resumes, schedules interviews, coordinates communication, and manages the applicant tracking system.
HR Manager	Approves requisitions and offers, ensures compliance with policy, and oversees the overall hiring process.
Interview Panel	Evaluates candidates against defined competencies and provides structured feedback.
New Employee	Completes required documentation, attends induction, and fulfills joining formalities.
IT / Admin	Provisions system access, email ID, workstation, and physical resources before joining date.

4. Definitions & Abbreviations

Term	Definition
Manpower Requisition Form (MRF)	Formal request raised by a department to fill an approved vacancy.
ATS	Applicant Tracking System used to log and manage candidate applications.
Offer Letter	Formal written offer of employment issued to a selected candidate.
BGV	Background Verification — checks on a candidate's education, employment history, and references.
Induction	Structured orientation program for new employees covering policies, culture, and role expectations.
Probation Period	Initial employment period (typically 3–6 months) during which performance and fit are assessed.

5. Procedure

5.1 Manpower Planning & Requisition

Step 1 — Identify Vacancy: Hiring Manager identifies the need for a new or replacement role and defines the job description, required skills, experience level, and reporting structure.

Step 2 — Raise Requisition: Hiring Manager submits a Manpower Requisition Form (MRF) with budget approval and headcount justification to HR.

Step 3 — Approve Requisition: HR Manager and relevant approver (e.g., department head/Finance) review and approve the MRF before sourcing begins.

5.2 Sourcing & Screening

Step 4 — Post the Job: HR Recruiter publishes the job opening on career portals, job boards, LinkedIn, internal referral channels, and/or engages recruitment agencies as needed.

Step 5 — Source Candidates: Recruiter actively sources candidates through the ATS, referrals, and headhunting for niche or senior roles.

Step 6 — Screen Resumes: Recruiter reviews applications against the job description, shortlisting candidates who meet minimum qualifications and experience criteria.

Step 7 — Initial HR Screening Call: Recruiter conducts a short call to confirm basic fit — notice period, salary expectations, location, and availability.

5.3 Interview & Assessment

Step 8 — Schedule Interviews: Recruiter coordinates interview slots between shortlisted candidates and the interview panel, sharing relevant candidate profiles in advance.

Step 9 — Conduct Technical/Functional Round: Hiring Manager or panel evaluates domain skills, problem-solving ability, and role-specific competencies.

Step 10 — Conduct HR/Culture-Fit Round: HR evaluates communication, cultural alignment, and career motivation.

Step 11 — Assessment Tests (if applicable): Candidates for select roles complete a skills test, case study, or work sample assignment.

Step 12 — Consolidate Feedback: All interviewers submit structured feedback and a hire/no-hire recommendation in the ATS.

5.4 Selection & Offer

Step 13 — Shortlist Final Candidate: HR and Hiring Manager jointly review feedback and select the preferred candidate.

Step 14 — Compensation Approval: HR prepares a compensation proposal and obtains approval from the HR Manager/Finance as per the approval matrix.

Step 15 — Extend Verbal Offer: Recruiter communicates the verbal offer and confirms candidate acceptance and expected joining date.

Step 16 — Issue Offer Letter: HR issues a formal offer letter stating role, compensation, joining date, and terms of employment for candidate signature.

5.5 Pre-Boarding & Verification

Step 17 — Initiate Background Verification: HR triggers BGV covering education, prior employment, and reference checks through an approved vendor or internal process.

Step 18 — Collect Joining Documents: HR collects ID proof, address proof, educational certificates, prior employment documents, and bank details from the candidate.

Step 19 — Coordinate Resource Setup: HR notifies IT/Admin to prepare the workstation, email ID, system access, and access card ahead of the joining date.

5.6 Onboarding & Induction

Step 20 — Day 1 Formalities: HR welcomes the new hire, completes joining formalities, and issues the employee ID and welcome kit.

- Step 21 — Induction Program:** New hire attends induction covering company policies, code of conduct, benefits, and reporting structure.
- Step 22 — Role-Specific Orientation:** Hiring Manager introduces the new hire to the team and outlines role expectations, goals, and initial training plan.
- Step 23 — Buddy Assignment:** HR assigns a peer buddy to support the new hire through their first weeks.

5.7 Confirmation

- Step 24 — Probation Review:** Hiring Manager conducts periodic check-ins and a formal performance review before the end of the probation period.
- Step 25 — Confirmation Letter:** Upon satisfactory performance, HR issues a confirmation letter converting the employee to permanent status.

6. Records & Documentation Maintained

- Manpower Requisition Form (MRF)
- Candidate resumes and interview feedback forms
- Offer letter and acceptance record
- Background verification report
- Joining checklist and submitted documents
- Induction attendance record
- Probation review and confirmation letter

7. Related Documents / References

- Recruitment Policy
- Compensation & Benefits Policy
- Code of Conduct
- Background Verification Policy
- Employee Handbook

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	22-Jul-2026	Initial release	HR Manager